

Media Plus Pandemic (MPP) Data Codebook v1.0

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This codebook provides the basic variables derived from the four merged sources. See main text for details.

- A) Media Sentiment: RavenPack Coronavirus Monitor
- B) COVID-19 Infection Rates: Johns Hopkins
- C) Government Pandemic Policy Interventions: Oxford Blavatnik School of Government
- D) Public Attitudes and Behaviours: Perceptions and Behaviors Surveys

Variable Name	Source / Category	Type	Description
iso3c	Custom / ID	String	ISO 3166-1 alpha-3 character country code (e.g., USA, DEU).
day	Custom / ID	Date	The exact date of the observation in YYYY-MM-DD format.
sent	Custom / ID	Numeric	RavenPack Coronavirus Monitor sentiment score tracking daily media and news sentiment.
country	Geography / Demographics	String	The country name or identifier.
region	Geography / Demographics	String	Broad geographic region (e.g., State, Province, or macro-region).
subregion	Geography / Demographics	String	Granular geographic area (e.g., County or municipality).
pop	Geography / Demographics	Numeric	Total population size for the specified geographic location (World Bank WDI).
cases	Johns Hopkins	Numeric	Cumulative count of confirmed COVID-19 cases.

Variable Name	Source / Category	Type	Description
cases_pc	Johns Hopkins	Numeric	Cumulative confirmed cases per capita (adjusted by pop).
cases_week	Johns Hopkins	Numeric	Rolling 7-day or weekly total of new confirmed cases.
cases_week_delta	Johns Hopkins	Numeric	Week-over-week change (difference) in new cases.
infection_total	Johns Hopkins	Numeric	Cumulative total infections (may differ from cases if estimated via modeling).
infection_day	Johns Hopkins	Numeric	Daily incident (new) infections.
infection_pc	Johns Hopkins	Numeric	Cumulative infections per capita.
infection_day_pc	Johns Hopkins	Numeric	Daily incident infections per capita.
infection_pc_3roll	Johns Hopkins	Numeric	3-day rolling average of cumulative infections per capita (used to smooth reporting anomalies).
infection_day_pc_3roll	Johns Hopkins	Numeric	3-day rolling average of daily incident infections per capita.
infection_day_delta	Johns Hopkins	Numeric	Day-over-day change in the number of new daily infections.
infection_week_delta	Cases & Infections	Numeric	Week-over-week change in new infections.
infection_young	Johns Hopkins (O'Driscoll et al., 2021)	Numeric	Cumulative infections attributed to the "young" age cohort.
infection_day_young	Johns Hopkins (O'Driscoll et al., 2021)	Numeric	Daily incident infections attributed to the "young" age cohort.
infection_old	Johns Hopkins (O'Driscoll et al., 2021)	Numeric	Cumulative infections attributed to the "old" age cohort.

Variable Name	Source / Category	Type	Description
infection_day_old	Johns Hopkins (O'Driscoll et al., 2021)	Numeric	Daily incident infections attributed to the "old" age cohort.
deaths	Johns Hopkins	Numeric	Cumulative count of COVID-19 deaths.
deaths_pc	Johns Hopkins	Numeric	Cumulative deaths per capita.
deaths_day	Johns Hopkins	Numeric	Daily incident (new) deaths.
deaths_6roll	Johns Hopkins	Numeric	6-day rolling average of cumulative deaths.
deaths_day_6roll	Johns Hopkins	Numeric	6-day rolling average of daily incident deaths (smooths weekend reporting lags).
deaths_young	Johns Hopkins (O'Driscoll et al., 2021)	Numeric	Cumulative deaths attributed to the "young" age cohort.
deaths_day_young	Johns Hopkins (O'Driscoll et al., 2021)	Numeric	Daily incident deaths attributed to the "young" age cohort.
death_lag18	Johns Hopkins	Numeric	Cumulative deaths shifted backward by 18 days (used to align fatalities with the time of initial infection).
death_day_lag18	Johns Hopkins	Numeric	Daily incident deaths shifted backward by 18 days.
infection_pc18	Johns Hopkins	Numeric	Cumulative infections per capita, lagged by 18 days.
active	Johns Hopkins	Numeric	Active cases, calculated as: Confirmed - Recovered - Deaths.
C1 - C8	OxCGRT (Containment)	Ordinal	Evaluates strictness of lockdowns (e.g., School/workplace closing, restrictions on gatherings, stay-at-home rules, travel controls).

Variable Name	Source / Category	Type	Description
E1 - E4	OxCGRT (Economic)	Ordinal	Evaluates economic safety nets (e.g., Income support, debt/contract relief).
H1 - H8	OxCGRT (Health)	Ordinal	Evaluates public health rules (e.g., Public information, testing policy, contact tracing, facial coverings).
V1 - V4	OxCGRT (Vaccination)	Ordinal	Tracks vaccine rollout (e.g., Prioritisation, eligibility, financial support).
StringencyIndex	OxCGRT (Indices)	Numeric	Records the strictness of lockdown-style policies (0-100 scale).
GovernmentResponseIndex	OxCGRT (Indices)	Numeric	A composite measure taking into account all containment, economic, and health policies (0-100 scale).
ContainmentHealthIndex	OxCGRT (Indices)	Numeric	Combines lockdown restrictions and health measures (0-100 scale).
EconomicSupportIndex	OxCGRT (Indices)	Numeric	Records measures of economic support (0-100 scale).
concern_self	Behaviors Survey (Hensel et al., 2020)	Numeric	Mean index of self-reported personal concerns related to COVID-19 (Corona_concerns_1-3).
concern_society	Behaviors Survey (Hensel et al., 2020)	Numeric	Mean index of self-reported societal concerns related to COVID-19 (Corona_concerns_4-5).
cis_cases	Behaviors Survey (Hensel et al., 2020)	Numeric	Count of survey respondents within the country-time grouping used to calculate the mean scores. Recommended not to use under 200.

Variable Name	Source / Category	Type	Description
behave	Behaviors Survey (Yamada et al., 2021)	Numeric	A weighted index of self-reported preventative behaviors calculated from factor loadings as: $(\text{stay} + 0.776 \cdot \text{gather} + 1.083 \cdot \text{distance}) / 3$. The components are standardized from: <i>beh_stayhome</i> (stay), <i>beh_socgathering</i> (gather), and <i>beh_distance</i> (distance).